



NXG-HUB DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES

The Nigerian Tech

Job Readiness Checklist

*Everything you need to have in place before applying for
your first professional tech role.*

How to use this checklist

Work through each section in order. Tick every item you can genuinely confirm and not the ones you are planning to do. The gaps you find are your action list.

Come back to this document every 4–6 weeks and track your progress. By the time every box is ticked, you are ready.

This checklist covers 10 tech tracks

1. Frontend
2. Backend
3. Product Design (UI/UX)
4. DevOps
5. Data Analysis
6. Product Management
7. Project Management
8. 3D Graphics
9. Digital Marketing
10. Motion Design.



Section 1: Your Foundation

Before anything else, you need to be clear on what you're pursuing and why. Clarity here saves months of unfocused effort.

- ☐ **Your track is chosen and committed to** - You're not switching between three tracks at once. One focus, done properly.
- ☐ **You have at least 1 year of consistent, documented self-study** - Consistent means regular, not occasional. Documented means you have something to show for it.
- ☐ **You know the specific role you're targeting** - "I want to work in tech" is not a target. "I want to be a frontend developer at a Nigerian fintech" is.
- ☐ **You understand the difference between your current level and entry-level professional expectations** - Research job descriptions for the roles you want. Know what the gap looks like.
- ☐ **You have a clear reason for pursuing this career that you can articulate out loud** because Interviewers will ask and "I like tech" is not an answer.

Section 2: Your Portfolio

Your portfolio is the first thing a hiring manager checks before deciding whether to read your CV. It needs to demonstrate that you solve real problems and not that you can follow tutorials.

GENERAL - ALL TRACKS

- ☐ **You have at least 2–3 portfolio projects that reflect real use cases.** Not tutorial clones. Projects that solve an actual problem, even a personal or community one.
- ☐ **Each project clearly states the problem, your approach, and the outcome.** Anyone reading it should understand what existed before you started and what changed because of your work.
- ☐ **Your portfolio is publicly accessible and loads correctly on both desktop and mobile.** A broken link or a site that doesn't load on mobile is an instant disqualifier.
- ☐ **You can speak confidently about every project in your portfolio under pressure.** If you can't explain a decision you made on a project, remove it.
- ☐ **Your portfolio does not contain unfinished or placeholder projects.** Half-built projects signal that you don't complete what you start.

TRACK-SPECIFIC PORTFOLIO REQUIREMENTS

Software Engineering (Frontend & Backend)

Your code tells the story your CV can't. Make sure it is readable.

- ☐ GitHub profile is active, consistent, and shows recent commits
- ☐ Each repository has a clear README, i.e., what it does, how to run it and why you built it
- ☐ Code is clean, commented where necessary, and organised logically
- ☐ At least one full-stack or end-to-end project is live and accessible via a URL
- ☐ You have used version control properly, commits are descriptive, not "fixed stuff"

Product Design (UI/UX)

Recruiters want to see your thinking, not just your visuals.

- ☐ At least one full case study exists, with research, problem definition, iterations and final design
- ☐ Figma files are organised, labelled, and shareable with view access
- ☐ Your work demonstrates user empathy, not just aesthetic preference
- ☐ You can explain why every design decision was made, not just what it looks like
- ☐ Portfolio includes both mobile and desktop design work

DevOps

Demonstrate that you understand infrastructure, automation, and reliability, not just tooling.

- ☐ GitHub shows infrastructure-as-code projects, CI/CD configurations, or automation scripts
- ☐ At least one project demonstrates a deployment pipeline you set up and can explain end-to-end
- ☐ You can speak to monitoring, logging and incident response even at a basic level
- ☐ Your README files explain the architecture decisions, not just how to run the code
- ☐ You have documented a real or simulated problem you diagnosed and resolved

Data Analysis

Data work lives and dies on how clearly you communicate findings. Show both the analysis and the story.

- ☐ At least two projects demonstrate the full workflow: data collection, cleaning, analysis, visualisation and insight
- ☐ Notebooks (Jupyter or similar) are clean, annotated and readable by a non-technical audience
- ☐ Dashboards are published and accessible. Tableau Public, Power BI, Google Looker Studio...
- ☐ You can explain your methodology and justify your analytical choices
- ☐ Your projects tell a story and the numbers lead to a conclusion someone would care about

Product Management

PM portfolios require evidence of structured thinking, not just ideas.

- ☐ You have at least one Product Requirements Document (PRD) or product brief to show
- ☐ You have documented a product decision, be it a feature prioritisation, a roadmap or a trade-off, with your reasoning
- ☐ You understand and can apply a prioritisation framework (RICE, MoSCoW, etc.)
- ☐ You have evidence of user research informing a product decision
- ☐ Your portfolio demonstrates business awareness, not just feature ideation

Project Management

Show that you can bring order to complexity through documentation that proves it.

- ☐ You have documented project plans, timelines, or work breakdown structures from a real or simulated project
- ☐ You can demonstrate risk identification and how you mitigated or responded to it
- ☐ You have used at least one project management tool (Jira, Trello, Asana, Notion) and can show your workflow
- ☐ You understand Agile and Waterfall methodologies and know when each applies
- ☐ You have a stakeholder communication example, either an update, a report or a summary

3D Graphics

Your reel is your portfolio. Quality over quantity, always.

- ☐ You have a showreel or portfolio link featuring your 3–5 strongest pieces
- ☐ Work demonstrates a range of at least two: modelling, texturing, lighting, animation, or rendering
- ☐ You can name and navigate the software you used (Blender, Maya, Cinema 4D, etc.) confidently
- ☐ At least one project was built to a brief, either a client brief, a self-imposed brief or a course project with clear constraints
- ☐ File naming, organisation, and project documentation are professional and not just raw exports

Digital Marketing

Anyone can post content. Show that you understand strategy, measurement, and results.

- ☐ You have at least one campaign case study with objective, strategy, execution and results
- ☐ Your work includes real metrics like reach, engagement, conversions, or cost per result
- ☐ You understand the difference between organic and paid strategy and can speak to both
- ☐ You have worked with at least one analytics platform (Google Analytics, Meta Ads Manager, etc.)
- ☐ You have writing samples like ad copy, captions, email copy or content strategy documents

Motion Design

Motion work is felt before it is analysed. Make sure your reel shows craft and intention.

- ☐ You have a showreel of 60–90 seconds featuring your best motion work
- ☐ Work demonstrates timing, easing, and composition and not just technical execution
- ☐ You can explain the creative and strategic intent behind each piece
- ☐ You are proficient in at least one industry-standard tool (After Effects, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve)
- ☐ At least one piece was created for a real or simulated brief with a defined objective

Section 3: Your CV & Online Presence

Your CV and LinkedIn profile work together. Most people treat them as separate documents, but they should tell the same story.

CV

- ☐ **Your CV is one page** - Unless you have 5+ years of professional experience, one page is the standard. Edit ruthlessly. *Unless in extreme cases.*
- ☐ **Your CV headline reflects the role you want, not a generic title** - "Frontend Developer" is better than "Tech Enthusiast" or "Self-Taught Programmer."
- ☐ **Every bullet point under your experience describes an outcome, not a task** - "Built a responsive e-commerce site that reduced checkout time by 30%" beats "Built websites."
- ☐ **Your CV contains zero spelling or grammar errors** - One error is enough for a hiring manager to stop reading. Use Grammarly and have someone else read it.
- ☐ **You are using a professional email address** - `firstname.lastname@gmail.com`. Not a nickname you've had since secondary school. e.g., olusegun.adekunle@gmail.com works better than segzykunle@gmail.com
- ☐ Your CV links directly to your portfolio and GitHub/Behance/relevant platform

LINKEDIN

- ☐ Your LinkedIn profile photo is professional, clear, well-lit and has an appropriate background
- ☐ **Your headline says what you do and who you help, not just your current job title** - "Frontend Developer | Building accessible web products" is more useful than "Student."
- ☐ **Your About section tells your story in your own voice with background, skills and direction** - Three to five sentences in first person. No buzzwords.
- ☐ All portfolio projects are listed under the Featured or Projects section
- ☐ Your skills section reflects your actual track and not every tool you have ever heard of
- ☐ You are connected with at least 50 people in the Nigerian tech space

Note: *LinkedIn is where Nigerian tech recruiters search first. A weak profile is a missed opportunity, even when your portfolio is strong.*

Section 4: Application Readiness

Most applications fail before anyone reads them because the applicant has not done the groundwork. This section is about showing up prepared.

- ☐ **You have researched each company before applying** - Know what they build, who their customers are, and what problems they're solving. Generic applications get ignored.
- ☐ **Your application materials are tailored to each role** - Copying and pasting the same CV and cover letter to 50 companies is not a strategy.
- ☐ **Your personal statement or cover letter speaks to the specific role and not just your background** - "I'm a great fit for this role because..." should be answered with their job description in mind.
- ☐ **You can explain every item on your CV and every project in your portfolio under interview pressure** - If you built it, you should be able to walk through it from memory.
- ☐ **You have practised answering: "Tell me about yourself"** - This is almost always the first question. Have a 90-second version ready.
- ☐ **You have practised answering: "Why are you switching to tech?" or "Why this role?"** - For career switchers especially, this question will come up in every interview.
- ☐ **You know your salary expectation and can justify it calmly** - Research market rates. Have a number. Don't say "anything is fine."
- ☐ **You have 2–3 questions ready to ask the interviewer** - Not asking questions signals you're not serious about the role.

Note: *Applying for 100 roles without preparation is less effective than applying for 10 roles after thorough research. Depth beats volume at this stage.*

Section 5: Professional Behaviour Readiness

Skills get you hired. Professional behaviour determines whether you stay, grow and get referred. This section is the one most self-taught individuals skip and the one that matters most once you're in the room.

- ☐ **You understand the difference between self-study pace and professional deadlines** - In self-study, you decide when something is done. In a job, someone else does. This shift is harder than it sounds.
- ☐ **You can receive critical feedback without becoming defensive or shutting down** - Feedback in a professional environment is frequent and direct. The ability to hear it, process it, and apply it is a career skill.
- ☐ **You know how to communicate blockers before they become missed deadlines** - "I'm stuck and didn't say anything until the deadline passed" ends contracts. Learn to flag problems early.
- ☐ **You have used at least one professional collaboration tool** - Slack for communication, Notion or Confluence for documentation, Jira or Trello for task management, Figma for design handoff. Pick the one relevant to your track.
- ☐ You understand basic meeting etiquette such as showing up on time, being prepared, not multitasking...
- ☐ **You can write a professional update or status report in plain, clear language** - No jargon. No walls of text. State what's done, what's in progress, and what's blocked.
- ☐ **You take ownership of your mistakes rather than deflecting or making excuses** - Accountability is one of the most valued traits in any professional environment. It is also one of the rarest.

Section 6: Interview Preparation

An interview is a performance you can prepare for. Most people walk in hoping for the best. Prepare specifically and it shows.

- ☐ **You have completed at least two mock interviews** - With a friend, a mentor or a practice tool. Out loud and timed, not rehearsed in your head.
- ☐ **You have practised technical or skill-based questions relevant to your track** - Frontend: browser rendering, component architecture, accessibility. Data: SQL, cleaning approaches and visualisation choices. Design: critique of your own work. Know what's coming.
- ☐ You can walk through a project from your portfolio in under 3 minutes without notes
- ☐ Your virtual interview setup is tested, the camera, microphone, lighting and background are all professional.
- ☐ You know the company's products well enough to reference them naturally in the interview
- ☐ **You have prepared for the "weakness" question with a genuine, growth-oriented answer** - Not "I work too hard." A real weakness and a real plan to address it.
- ☐ You know what happens next - the interview stages, timeline, and who to follow up with

Note: *The best interviews feel like conversations, not interrogations. That only happens when you are prepared enough to be relaxed.*

Ready to go further?

The NXG-HUB Job Shadowing Program gives self-taught individuals the one thing no checklist can provide. Real professional experience on live projects, under the guidance of industry mentors, with a direct referral pipeline to partner companies.

12 Weeks | 10 Tracks | 10 - 15 Slots per track | ₦100,000 / \$100
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